



JOSE LUIS MAGANA Associated Press

### THE SHOW MIGHT NOT GO ON

Kennedy Center board votes to close venue as judge again blocks addition of Trump’s name. **NATION, A5**

## POSTFIRE REVIEW URGES COUNTY REFORMS

Report calls out the need to update and formalize recovery plans for future crises.

By GRACE TOOHEY

Facing the greatest disaster in Los Angeles history, the county government did not have the plans and procedures in place it needed to jump-start a recovery after the January 2025 fires, a new review found.

The report offered a slew of reforms to ensure the region is better prepared for the next major emergency and found that — despite outdated or absent plans — county employees and partners worked hard to provide many of the resources and support that fire survivors needed, often under exceptionally challenging circumstances.

The report also noted that several recommendations made after the Woolsey fire, which destroyed more than 1,100 homes in L.A. County in 2018, had not been addressed by the time of the 2025 firestorms — and continued to hurt the county’s effectiveness.

The report, which examined the first three months after the firestorms, is the second major after-action review ordered by the county Board of Supervisors and carried out by McChrystal Group, a consulting firm based in Alexandria, Va. It said L.A. County employees and partners navigated the immediate recovery of the Eaton and Palisades fires [See **Wildfires, A8**]

## Economic win for L.A. is forecast for ’28 Games

By JAMES RAINEY

The 2028 Summer Olympic Games in Los Angeles will deliver a bounty to Southern California in more ways than one, generating a surge of up to \$40.6 billion in increased economic output and adding as many as 224,000 jobs, according to an economic analysis released Tuesday.

Those projections were at the high end of the economic forecast conducted by the Los Angeles County Economic Development Corp. at the request of LA28, the Olympics organizing committee. One scenario put the increased economic output at \$20.5 billion to \$25.4 billion, while the other predicted increased output at roughly \$35.4 billion to \$40.6 billion.

Those estimates include the run-up to the Games over the next two years. The report doesn’t attempt to measure what sort of economic impact would follow in the months and years after the Olympics conclude.

“This study shows the tremendous opportunity we have to support jobs, open doors for local businesses, and drive investments that strengthen communities across Los Angeles,” Reynold Hoover, chief executive of LA28, said in a statement.

The authors of the study acknowledged that projections of future economic activity can be overly rosy “particularly when they rely on optimistic assumptions about attendance or visitor spending.” That’s what happened in the case of the 2024 Paris Olympics, French government auditors found.

An economic forecast by a think tank before the 2024 Games projected the Paris Olympics would generate up to \$12.8 billion in net economic benefits. But government auditors concluded in 2025 that the Olympics injected a more modest \$2.3 billion into the economy, an almost negligible [See **Olympics, A10**]

## Nick Reiner will not face death penalty, D.A. says

Hochman says he made decision after ‘rigorous review,’ talk with victims’ family.

By JAMES QUEALLY

Nick Reiner won’t face the death penalty when he stands trial for allegedly killing his parents, beloved Hollywood icons Rob and Michele Reiner, Los Angeles County’s top prosecutor said Tuesday morning.

Dist. Atty. Nathan Hochman said the decision followed a “rigorous review” that included discussions with the Reiner family about their desired outcomes in the case.

Reiner, 32, is accused of stabbing his parents inside their Brentwood home in the middle of the night on Dec.

14. He was arrested in Exposition Park about 12 hours after his sister, Romy, discovered the bodies, police have said.

“This decision reflects our careful judgment about the most appropriate path to take in this case and does not diminish the severity of these crimes,” Hochman said in a statement. “I have spoken to the Reiner family and evaluated the mitigating and aggravating factors that are part of special circumstance murder cases. Seeking capital punishment should be reserved for the most egregious instances.”

A grand jury indicted Reiner on murder charges last month and upheld an allegation that he “lay in wait” to ambush his parents. He has pleaded not guilty.

The grand jury transcripts have not been made public and prosecutors have

offered little information about a possible motive in the crime. A motion to unseal those transcripts is expected to be heard next month.

Deputy L.A. County Public Defender Kimberly Greene, who took over representing Reiner after high-profile attorney Alan Jackson dropped out this year, said in a statement that Hochman had made “the right decision.”

“Nick has a serious mental illness and a long history of struggling with self-medication,” Greene said. “His circumstances are a tragic example of how difficult it can be for people experiencing significant mental health challenges to access and navigate the treatment and support they need.”

Reiner has spoken publicly about his struggles with [See **Reiner, A8**]

## Oil market shock is feared as Iran throttles supply

Pipeline attack and Houthi advance may further boost price before midterms.

By MICHAEL WILNER

WASHINGTON — A bold military push by Iran and its proxies to create a choke hold on global oil supplies has once again caught the Trump administration off guard, threatening a market shock and a steep political backlash in the U.S. midterm elections.

A drone attack on Saudi Arabia’s most crucial pipeline, which siphons crude oil from the Persian Gulf to the Red Sea to bypass the Strait of Hormuz, has led to the line’s closure, potentially taking 4% of the world’s supply off the market.

And a lightning advance by Iran-backed Houthi rebels along Yemen’s Red Sea coast threatens commercial traffic through the Bab el-Mandeb Strait, second only to Hormuz in its importance to regional shipping.

The strikes put the Trump administration in a newly precarious position less than two months until the November midterms. President Trump’s military advisors have warned him that any retaliation could

lead to a further depletion of critically low U.S. munition stockpiles, endanger American personnel in the field and risk escalation that could spiral out of Washington’s control.

On Tuesday, the global price of oil topped \$107 a barrel — the first time in U.S. campaign history that an incumbent president has faced rising pump prices at this stage of an election.

The Iranian strikes come as Europe and the United States are facing increased energy needs entering the fall and winter months, and as Ukrainian attacks on Russia’s energy infrastructure have surged, pushing diesel prices up to record highs.

Signs are emerging that the latest attacks could trigger an acute market panic, with Brent crude buyers paying a steep premium for early delivery — an indication that the industry fears an impending supply crisis.

“I fear there is a considerable risk of much higher gas and diesel prices in the weeks to come,” said Michael O’Hanlon, director of research of the foreign policy program at the Brookings Institution.

“No one is quite sure how to predict the fuel markets,” he added, “but the military dynamics are seriously wor- [See **Oil, A6**]



GREGORY BULL Associated Press

**UNWELCOME** signs in Carlsbad, Calif., last week. The global price of oil topped \$107 a barrel Tuesday.

## Trump seeks redo of climate report

White House wants to revise the findings of a federal assessment published 3 years ago.

By HAYLEY SMITH

The Trump administration is seeking to revise a federal climate report published three years ago to recast worst-case climate scenarios as implausible and limit their use in federal decision-making.

The White House has proposed an “amendment and clarification” to the findings of the National Climate Assessment 5, published in 2023. National Climate Assessments are congressionally mandated reports composed by hundreds of scientists and researchers and have been published every four years since 1990.

Now, the White House wants to go back and change how the highest-emission

scenarios — those representing the worst possible outcomes of climate change, known technically as RCP8.5 — can be interpreted and used by the federal government.

The proposal comes from the U.S. Global Change Research Program within the White House’s Office of Science and Technology Policy and was published in the Federal Register.

RCP8.5 or other equivalent pathways “are not policy relevant, and should not be used in authoritative federal work products,” officials wrote in the proposed amendment.

National climate assessments are important because their projections can inform federal infrastructure planning, risk assessments, regulations, disaster preparedness and cost-benefit analyses, including from hazards such as wildfires, floods, drought and sea-level rise.

[See **Climate, A6**]

## AI use risks ‘cognitive stunting’ in kids

Los Angeles Unified School District recently announced it will bar student use of generative artificial intelligence on school devices for the 2026-27 academic year, joining New York City’s public schools in limiting children’s access to a technology no one yet knows how to safely manage.

The nation’s two largest school districts made the move at a pivotal moment in the technology’s evolution. Last week, a former engineer for OpenAI and Anthropic warned that AI’s chief architects “earnestly believe that it could kill us all by the end of the decade.”

It’s been less than four years since the public debut of ChatGPT, the first widely adopted generative AI platform. Given the relative nov-

Shortcuts allow them to bypass crucial learning, researchers warn

By Corinne Purtill



CHRISTINA HOUSE Los Angeles Times

**AN LAUSD** student uses an AI-assisted learning tool in 2024. A moratorium is now in place in the district.

elty of publicly accessible generative AI, the total body of research investigating its effect on children’s cognitive development is fairly small.

But the available data paint a worrisome picture of thwarted learning.

Without careful guardrails in place, children tend to use the platforms as shortcuts to answers, bypassing the messy, difficult cognitive processes that are essential for learning.

Researchers watching young children’s brain activity as they interacted with ChatGPT saw less engagement in regions associated with attention and information processing than they did in adults doing the same task. High school students permitted to use ChatGPT [See **AI, A7**]

### Bass skips hearing on homelessness

Mayor says L.A. “will not be bullied” by House Republicans’ claims of misuse of funds. **NATION, A5**

### Lawsuit calls out Metrolink safety

Fired executive alleges improper upkeep of equipment puts riders at risk. **CALIFORNIA, B1**

**Weather**  
Partly sunny.  
L.A. Basin: 80/67. **B6**

**Markets** ..... **A10**  
**Opinion Voices** ..... **A12**

### ‘American Idol’ is leaving L.A.

The competition show’s planned 25th season will be produced in Georgia. **BUSINESS, A9**

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